

Lighting Booth Runbook

Booth Check, the icon at the top right of the menu bar, starts the show and watches the Mac. This page is what's left for a person.

Show BackupChurch_modular_v33.lightkeyproj Stream Deck **Lightkey v33 Service Panel**

Booth Check **1.5+**

If the lights run away

Unplug the Stream Deck's USB cable and don't press anything else. If one press changes lots of cues, or Lightkey freezes, this stops it at once.
Run the rest of the service from Lightkey's own panel with the mouse, and tell whoever looks after the lighting afterwards.

Before every service

- 1

Plug the charger in. The lid can stay closed: the Mac runs from the external screen, keyboard and mouse, but only while it's on the charger. If the Mac is shut down, unplug the charger and plug it back in to start it.
- 2

Look at Booth Check in the menu bar. A tick means ready; a triangle or cross with a number means something needs fixing, so click it. When the Mac starts, Booth Check opens the show and Stream Deck itself, and opens its window if anything is wrong.
- 3

If Lightkey or the Stream Deck app isn't open, click the Booth Check icon → Get the show started. It opens the show, waits for Lightkey to be ready, then opens the Stream Deck app, in that order.
- 4

Hold Option and click Lightkey's green window button to make it fill the screen. Don't use true full screen: it moves Lightkey into its own space, and macOS can then let the Stream Deck app fall asleep.
- 5

In the Stream Deck app, check "Lightkey v33 Service Panel" is the profile in use. Booth Check can't see which profile is selected.
- 6

Press House 10% on the deck, then press it again. The house lights should come up and the key light, then both go off. If that works, the whole chain works.

Something's wrong

Find the symptom. "Now" is for whoever is in the booth; "For good" is the one-time setup below.

The Booth Check icon shows a triangle or a cross.	Something it checks needs attention. The number is how many things. NOWClick the icon. Each item says what to do; Open Booth Check shows the full list, with a button for each fix.
Deck keys do nothing — then they all fire at once when you click the Stream Deck app.	macOS has put the Stream Deck app to sleep. Your presses are queued inside it, not lost. NOWStop pressing — every queued press fires when it wakes. Click the Stream Deck app once. FOR GOODSetup 3 (App Nap), and never true full screen.
A key is lit but its cue isn't on, or the other way round.	The deck can only update keys on the page it's showing. Worship and flow, the two mover pages and the two bar pages share groups across pages. NOWPress any key on the page you're looking at. Lightkey's own panel is always right.
The deck does nothing at all, even with the app open.	Wrong profile, or Stream Deck started before Lightkey was ready. NOWPick "Lightkey v33 Service Panel". Still dead: quit and reopen the Stream Deck app. FOR GOODSetup 3 and 5, so Booth Check opens them in order.

Cues change in Lightkey but nothing lights up.

The USB DMX interface isn't reaching the lights. Booth Check's two DMX items help tell.

NOW

Reseat the DMX USB cable at both ends, then quit and reopen Lightkey.

Wrong looks, missing buttons or old cues.

An older show file is open.

NOW

File → Open Recent → BackupChurch_modular_v33 .

FOR GOOD

Booth Check → **Change...** to the right show.

"Allow accessory to connect?" appears, or a password after sitting idle.

Two macOS settings Booth Check can't read.

NOW

Click Allow, or type the password.

FOR GOOD

Setup 4.

The screen went black or the Mac went to sleep.

It's running on battery, or its screen settings turned the display off.

NOW

Plug the charger in, then press a key on the external keyboard.

FOR GOOD

Booth Check's "Never sleeps on the charger" item (setup 3).

One-time setup Done once by whoever looks after the Mac.

- 1 Install Booth Check.** Download **Booth.Check.zip** from github.com/jimhoggey/BoothCheck-App/releases and drag Booth Check into Applications. First time only: right-click → Open → Open. After that it updates itself; click **Update** when offered, outside a service.
- 2 Choose the show and allow access.** **Choose show...** → the show file. Allow control of System Events when asked. On "The right show is open", click **Allow access...**, turn Booth Check on under Accessibility, then reopen it.
- 3 Work down Booth Check's list until everything is a tick.** Each item says what to do. Anything that changes the Mac shows the exact command first and runs only when you press Run; anything needing the admin password opens System Settings instead, except starting from the charger, which shows its one sudo command first.
- 4 The settings Booth Check can't see.** Privacy & Security → Allow accessories to connect → **Always**. Lock Screen → screen saver and "Require password..." → Never. Control Centre → Focus → Do Not Disturb, on.
- 5 Turn off the Stream Deck app's own "launch at login".** Booth Check opens it once Lightkey is ready; starting on its own, it can beat Lightkey and the keys stay dead.
- 6 Look after the battery.** An always-plugged-in Intel MacBook can swell its battery: turn on battery health management (System Settings → Battery → ⓘ next to Battery Health). If the case bulges or the trackpad lifts, get the battery replaced.

WITHOUT BOOTH CHECK

Switch App Nap off (then restart), and stop the Mac sleeping on the charger:

```
defaults write -g NSAppSleepDisabled -bool true
sudo pmset -c sleep 0 displaysleep 0 disksleep 0
```

Leave it on

Leave it on, plugged in and logged in, all week. With the lid closed, shut down from the Apple menu and start it by replugging the charger; a vertical stand keeps it cooler. Restart about **once a month**, a few days before a service, and install macOS updates then.

Why restarts ask for a password

With FileVault on, unlocking the disk is the login, so each restart needs the password once before Booth Check can start the show. Turning FileVault off allows automatic login, but anyone who takes the laptop could read it. Restarting rarely gets the same result.

Written for Booth Check 1.5 and the v33 show, 25 September 2026. When the show version changes, update the names at the top and choose the new show in Booth Check.